

PROFITABLE CAFE OPERATIONS GUIDE

Mexican Taqueria Elevated



BREAKFAST & LUNCH — 7:00AM TO 3:00PM

Full Recipe Cards • US Market Food Costing • Kitchen Prep Flow • Financial Forecast

Real Mexican technique. Nothing from a can. Nothing pre-made the week before.

32

SEATS

\$32

AVG SPEND

22%

FOOD COST TARGET

\$16,800

EST. MONTHLY NET

About This Guide: This is a fast-casual taqueria built for maximum throughput without sacrificing quality. The economics of taco service are excellent — low food cost, high cover turnover, proven menu items with extraordinary versatility. But the difference between a great taqueria and a mediocre one is technique: house-made masa, proper chili construction, 12-hour carnitas, hand-pressed tortillas. Every recipe here explains the why behind the technique so your team understands what they're making, not just how to follow steps.

THE STORY BEHIND THIS GUIDE

"Birria went viral. I had been making it my grandmother's way for fifteen years. The internet caught up to what Jalisco already knew."

Carlos grew up in Guadalajara where birria — slow-braised beef or goat, served in its own consomme, the tortilla dipped in the fat before hitting the griddle — is not a trend. It is a Sunday morning institution. It is what you eat after Mass, at a street stall that has been run by the same family for forty years, standing at a counter with paper napkins, watching the cook work the griddle with the unhurried confidence of someone who has made the same thing ten thousand times.

He moved to Phoenix at 24, started working in kitchens, and watched birria go from something his family made on Sundays to the most-searched taco on the internet. He watched restaurants open on the trend — many of them making birria with shortcuts, without the right chile combination, without the consomme, without the consome dip — and he watched guests who had never tasted real birria accept the imitation as the original.

The guide's birria recipe — the exact dried chile combination, the three-hour braise, the consomme reduction, the fat-dipping technique that creates the crispy cheese-pull taco — was the closest he had found to his grandmother's method in written form. The food cost box showing the birria taco at \$2.14 to make and \$13.99 to sell was the financial proof he needed that authenticity and profitability were not in conflict.

He opened a 36-seat taqueria in Phoenix's Roosevelt Row arts district. The birria consomme is made fresh every morning. The queue starts 20 minutes before

opening on weekends. Month three net: \$36,000. Mexican food is the most misunderstood cuisine in America. This guide is how you do it justice — and profit from doing it right.

Carlos M. · Mexican Taqueria · Roosevelt Row, Phoenix · Est. Month 3 Net: \$36,000

1 Entrées

Tortilla Chips & Guacamole

House-fried chips, tableside guacamole, salsa roja, salsa verde · Sell: \$12.99

5 min Entrée Target FC: 14%

Chips and Guac



INGREDIENTS (PER SERVE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Corn tortillas (cut, fried)	6 tortillas = 90g	\$0.48
Avocado (Hass, ripe)	1.5 avocados = 180g flesh	\$1.80
Lime juice (fresh)	20ml	\$0.12
White onion (fine dice)	30g	\$0.06
Jalapeño (minced)	10g	\$0.04
Cilantro (chopped)	5g	\$0.04
Salsa roja (batch)	60g	\$0.08
Salsa verde (batch)	60g	\$0.08
Total cost per serve		\$2.70

Cost per serve	\$2.70
Sell price	\$12.99
Food cost %	20.8%
Contribution margin	\$10.29

METHOD

- 1 Fry corn tortilla wedges in hot oil at **180°C / 356°F** for **90 seconds** until golden and rigid. Drain, season immediately with fine salt while hot. House-fried chips have a freshness and corn flavour that bagged chips cannot replicate — the difference is immediately obvious to guests. Fry in batches every 90 minutes through service to ensure chips are never more than 2 hours old.
- 2 Guacamole: halve avocados, remove pit, score flesh in a crosshatch pattern. Scoop into a bowl or molcajete. Add lime juice first — this prevents oxidation and begins to "season" the avocado before anything else is added. Add white onion, jalapeño, cilantro, salt. Mash to a chunky consistency — a few avocado chunks remaining is correct. Over-mashed guacamole becomes pale and baby-food in texture.
- 3 **Salsa roja (batch)**: Char roma tomatoes, white onion, jalapeño, and garlic directly on an open flame or comal until deeply blackened on the exterior — this charring is the flavour. Blend with water, cumin, salt. The blackened skins add smokiness and complexity. Simmer 10 minutes. Makes 20+ serves.
- 4 **Salsa verde (batch)**: Husk and rinse tomatillos. Char with onion and jalapeño on the comal. Blend with cilantro, lime, salt. Do not cook after blending — the raw cilantro in the verde is part of the bright, fresh character. Serve both salsas at room temperature, not refrigerator-cold.

Chef's Tip: The most common guacamole mistake is using unripe avocados because they look more structurally perfect. A ripe Hass avocado should yield to firm pressure but not feel mushy — the flesh should be creamy and yield to a fork without being applied force. An under-ripe avocado produces dense, flavourless guacamole. Better to 86 guac for a day than serve it with sub-standard avocados.

NIGHTSHADES CORN (chips)

Elote — Mexican Street Corn

Charred corn, cotija, chipotle mayo, lime · Sell: \$8.99

6 min Entrée Target FC: 16%



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Fresh corn (1 ear)	180g kernels on cob	\$0.55
Cotija cheese (crumbled)	30g	\$0.54
Mayo + chipotle in adobo	40g + 5g	\$0.22
Lime (juice + wedge)	20ml	\$0.12
Tajín + chili powder	2g	\$0.02
Cilantro (garnish)	3g	\$0.02
Total cost per serve		\$1.47

Cost per serve	\$1.47
Sell price	\$8.99
Food cost %	16.4%
Contribution margin	\$7.52

METHOD

- 1 Char corn on a comal or flat grill at **220°C / 428°F** — rotate every 90 seconds for 5–6 minutes total. The corn should have dark char spots on approximately 30–40% of the kernels. This char is the flavour — the Maillard reaction creates sweetness, smoke, and depth that raw or simply boiled corn cannot produce.
- 2 Chipotle mayo: blend 100g mayo with 2 chipotles in adobo + 5ml adobo sauce. This is a batch item — holds 1 week refrigerated. The balance should be smoky, slightly spicy, creamy — not overwhelmingly hot. Adjust chipotle quantity to the heat level of your specific chipotle brand.
- 3 Service: brush corn with chipotle mayo generously. Roll in crumbled cotija. Dust with Tajín and chili powder. Serve with a lime wedge and cilantro. The combination of charred corn + tangy cheese + smoky mayo + Tajín's citrus-chili tang is one of the most flavour-complete street foods in the world — every element has a defined role.

Chef's Tip: Cotija is the correct cheese — its dry, salty, crumbly nature clings to the mayo coating. Parmesan or feta are acceptable substitutes but produce a different result. Fresh cotija is not the same as aged cotija — for elote, aged cotija provides the right texture and salt level. If you cannot source cotija, finely grated aged Pecorino Romano works.

DAIRY (cotija) EGGS (mayo)

Birria Quesadilla

Braised beef birria, Oaxacan cheese, consommé dip · Sell: \$14.99

8 min Entrée Target FC: 22%

Birria Quesadilla



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Birria beef (batch)	80g	\$1.04
Corn tortillas (2, large)	60g	\$0.32
Oaxacan/Quesillo cheese	60g	\$0.84
Birria consommé (dipping)	100ml	\$0.22
White onion + cilantro (garnish)	20g	\$0.06
Dried chili oil (from birria)	15ml	\$0.04
Total cost per serve		\$2.52

Cost per serve	\$2.52
Sell price	\$14.99
Food cost %	16.8%
Contribution margin	\$12.47

BIRRIA METHOD (BATCH — BRAISE 4+ HOURS DAY BEFORE)

- 1 Toast dried chilis: guajillo (6), ancho (3), árbol (2) on a dry comal 20 seconds each side — they should puff slightly and become fragrant. Do not burn — black chilis become bitter. Soak in boiling water 20 minutes to rehydrate. Blend soaked chilis with the soaking water, tomatoes, garlic, onion, cumin, oregano, cloves, black pepper. This is the adobo paste.
- 2 Sear 1kg beef chuck in batches until deeply browned on all sides. Transfer to a deep pot. Cover with adobo paste. Add enough water to barely submerge. Bring to boil, skim foam. Reduce to a bare simmer. Braise **4 hours minimum** until beef shreds with no resistance. Internal temp: **95°C / 203°F**. The fat that rises to the surface is the birria oil — collect it. It will be used to fry the tortillas for a deep red, flavoursome crust.
- 3 Shred beef, return to consommé. The consommé should be rich, deeply flavoured, with the red colour of the chili oil. Serve the consommé strained as the dipping broth alongside the quesadilla.
- 4 Service: brush corn tortillas with birria oil. Lay on hot comal. Add Oaxacan cheese and shredded birria. Fold. Press down. Cook 3 minutes each side — the tortilla should be deeply golden-red from the chili oil, crispy, and the cheese fully melted. Serve with a small bowl of hot consommé for dipping. The dip ritual is part of the experience — describe it to first-timers.

Chef's Tip: The birria oil — the rendered fat from the braising liquid — is one of the most flavourful fats in any taqueria kitchen. Use it to fry tortillas for all birria dishes and reserve any excess for adding depth to beans, rice, or other dishes. Never discard it. The colour it adds to the quesadilla (deep orange-red, impossibly appetising) is entirely from this oil — no other fat produces this result.

BEEF DAIRY (cheese) NIGHTSHADES CORN

Ceviche de Camarón

Shrimp, lime, tomato, cucumber, red onion, cilantro, tostada - Sell: \$14.99

6 min Entrée Target FC: 22%

Ceviche de Camarón



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Shrimp (31/40 count, cooked)	120g	\$1.68
Lime juice (fresh)	40ml	\$0.24
Roma tomato (seeded, diced)	80g	\$0.28
English cucumber (diced)	60g	\$0.22
Red onion (fine slice)	30g	\$0.08
Jalapeño (seeded, minced)	10g	\$0.04
Cilantro (chopped)	8g	\$0.06
Tostada (2 pieces)	30g	\$0.24
Total cost per serve		\$2.84

Cost per serve	\$2.84
Sell price	\$14.99
Food cost %	18.9%
Contribution margin	\$12.15

METHOD

- 1 Use pre-cooked shrimp — this is a safety decision. "Raw lime-cured" ceviche using shrimp requires HACCP-grade sourcing and food handler certification in most US states. Cooked shrimp marinated in lime for 15 minutes produces an excellent, safe ceviche. Refrigerate shrimp at 1-4°C and use within 48 hours of receipt. Never use previously frozen shrimp that has been thawed for more than 24 hours.
- 2 Combine shrimp with tomato, cucumber, red onion, jalapeño. Add fresh lime juice. The lime should coat everything — it is the marinade. Rest in the fridge 15 minutes minimum — this brief acid contact brightens the shrimp's flavour and marinates the vegetables without them going soft.
- 3 Add cilantro at the last moment — cilantro wilts and oxidises within minutes of contact with acid. Season with salt. The ceviche should taste bright, acidic, spicy, and the shrimp should be the star — they should taste of the sea, with the vegetables and cilantro playing supporting roles.
- 4 Serve piled on tostadas. The tostada provides the crunch contrast that the soft ceviche needs. Serve immediately — within 3 minutes of tostada assembly — because the tostada softens rapidly from the lime juice.

Chef's Tip: This dish photographs exceptionally well — the bright colours of red tomato, green cucumber, white onion, and orange-pink shrimp on a golden tostada is a natural social media image. Every weekend, photograph a fresh ceviche plating and post it. It communicates freshness, quality, and skill simultaneously.

SHELLFISH (shrimp) NIGHTSHADES CORN (tostada)

Carnitas Tacos (3-pack)

12-hour pork belly confit, double corn tortilla, onion, cilantro, lime · Sell: \$16.99

7 minMainTarget FC: 20%Batch

Carnitas Tacos



INGREDIENTS (3 TACOS)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Pork shoulder (carnitas batch)	120g cooked	\$0.88
Corn tortillas (6 small, doubled)	90g	\$0.48
White onion (finely diced)	30g	\$0.06
Cilantro (chopped)	8g	\$0.06
Lime (2 wedges)	30g	\$0.12
Salsa roja (side)	40g	\$0.06
Salsa verde (side)	40g	\$0.06
Total cost (3 tacos)		\$1.72

Cost per serve	\$1.72
Sell price	\$16.99
Food cost %	10.1%
Contribution margin	\$15.27

METHOD (BATCH CARNITAS — START NIGHT BEFORE OR MORNING)

- 1 Cut pork shoulder into 10cm chunks. Season with salt, pepper, cumin, dried oregano. Place in a deep pan or Dutch oven with orange juice (2 oranges), lime juice (2 limes), garlic (6 cloves), bay leaves. Add water to nearly cover. The citrus juice serves two functions: it tenderises the collagen and adds the characteristic bright acidity of proper carnitas.
- 2 Bring to a boil, skim foam. Reduce to a bare simmer — 90°C / 194°F. Cook uncovered for 2 hours, then allow most of the liquid to evaporate over the next 30–45 minutes, turning occasionally, until the pork is sitting in its own rendered fat and the exterior begins to caramelize. Internal temp: 90°C / 194°F.
- 3 Pull apart into medium chunks — not fine shreds. The pieces should be irregular: some crispy caramelised exterior, some tender interior. The contrast of textures is essential. Never shred carnitas to a uniform mince — this destroys the textural character.
- 4 Service: heat corn tortillas (doubled — two per taco is traditional for structural integrity and better corn flavour ratio) directly on the comal 30 seconds each side until pliable and slightly charred. Add 40g carnitas per taco. Top with white onion and cilantro only — the toppings are minimal by design; the meat is the focus. Serve with lime wedges and both salsas in small ramekins.

Chef's Tip: The doubling of corn tortillas is not wasteful — it is the authentic taqueria method, and it has practical reasons: a single corn tortilla will split under the weight of the filling, especially when moistened by juicy carnitas. Doubled tortillas provide structural integrity and significantly better corn flavour. Never use flour tortillas for carnitas tacos.

PORKCORNNIGHTSHADES

Al Pastor Tacos (3-pack)

Achiote-marinated pork, pineapple, onion, cilantro · Sell: \$16.99

7 min Main Target FC: 20% Batch

Al Pastor Tacos



INGREDIENTS (3 TACOS)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Pork shoulder (al pastor batch)	120g cooked	\$0.88
Corn tortillas (6 small, doubled)	90g	\$0.48
Fresh pineapple (grilled)	40g	\$0.20
White onion (fine dice)	25g	\$0.05
Cilantro	8g	\$0.06
Salsa roja	40g	\$0.06
Lime wedges	2	\$0.12
Total cost (3 tacos)		\$1.85

Cost per serve	\$1.85
Sell price	\$16.99
Food cost %	10.9%
Contribution margin	\$15.14

AL PASTOR MARINADE & METHOD (BATCH)

- 1 Marinade: blend 3 guajillo chilis (toasted, soaked), 2 ancho chilis, 1 chipotle in adobo, 30g achiote paste, 4 garlic cloves, 60ml pineapple juice, 30ml white vinegar, 5g cumin, 5g dried oregano, 5g salt. The achiote paste is non-negotiable — it provides the deep red-orange colour and the earthy, slightly floral flavour that defines al pastor. Without it, you have seasoned pork, not al pastor.
- 2 Slice pork shoulder 1cm thick. Coat thoroughly in marinade. Marinate minimum 4 hours, ideally overnight. The acid in the pineapple juice begins to tenderise the meat during marination — do not marinate longer than 18 hours as the pineapple enzymes (bromelain) will break the protein structure too aggressively and the texture becomes mushy.
- 3 Cook on a vertical spit (trompo) if available — this is the traditional method. Without a trompo, grill marinated pork slices on a ripping hot comal or griddle at **220°C / 428°F** until charred on the edges and cooked through. Internal temp: **71°C / 160°F**. Chop into small pieces after cooking — al pastor should be in small irregular chunks, not slices.
- 4 Grill pineapple slices on the comal until caramelised — 2 minutes per side. Dice. Heat doubled tortillas on the comal. Build taco: al pastor + grilled pineapple + white onion + cilantro. The pineapple is not optional or decorative — its sweetness and acid balance the rich, spiced pork. Al pastor without pineapple is technically just achiote pork.

Chef's Tip: The char on al pastor is the flavour. The slightly burnt edges of the achiote-coated pork, where the sugars in the marinade caramelize and carbonise slightly, create a bittersweet crust that contrasts with the tender interior. Do not be afraid of colour on this dish — pale al pastor is undercooked al pastor.

PORK NIGHTSHADES CORN

Fish Tacos Baja Style (3-pack)

Beer-battered white fish, cabbage slaw, chipotle crema, lime · Sell: \$17.99

10 min Main Target FC: 24%

Fish Tacos



INGREDIENTS (3 TACOS)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
White fish (cod/tilapia)	150g	\$2.10
Beer batter (batch)	60g batter	\$0.18
Corn tortillas (6, doubled)	90g	\$0.48
Cabbage slaw (batch)	60g	\$0.18
Chipotle crema (batch)	30g	\$0.22
Pico de gallo (batch)	40g	\$0.14
Lime wedges	2	\$0.12
Total cost (3 tacos)		\$3.42

Cost per serve	\$3.42
Sell price	\$17.99
Food cost %	19.0%
Contribution margin	\$14.57

METHOD

- Beer batter (batch): 150g plain flour + 5g baking powder + 5g salt + 5g cumin + 330ml cold lager beer. Whisk until just combined — lumps are acceptable and preferred. Over-mixing develops gluten and produces a dense, doughy batter instead of a light, crispy one. Keep batter cold — sit the bowl in an ice bath during service. Cold batter on hot oil creates maximum steam and lift.
- Cut fish into 50g pieces — uniform size ensures consistent cooking time. Pat completely dry before battering — moisture prevents the batter from adhering and causes violent oil splatter. Season fish directly with salt and a pinch of cumin before dipping in batter.
- Fry at 185°C / 365°F for 3–4 minutes until deep golden. The internal temp of the fish: 63°C / 145°F. Do not overcook — white fish goes dry and flaky at overcook. Drain on paper, season immediately with salt.
- Cabbage slaw: shredded white cabbage + lime juice + salt + pinch sugar. Make fresh daily — dressed slaw holds for 4 hours maximum before wilting. Chipotle crema: sour cream + chipotle in adobo + lime juice, blended smooth. Build tacos: fish piece + slaw + pico de gallo + chipotle crema drizzle. Serve immediately — battered fish goes soft within 5 minutes.

Chef's Tip: Temperature control of the frying oil is the difference between great and mediocre battered fish. Too hot (200°C+) and the batter burns before the fish cooks through. Too cool (under 175°C) and the batter absorbs oil and becomes greasy. Use a probe thermometer on the oil. If you don't have a thermometer, drop a small amount of batter in — it should rise to the surface within 3 seconds and begin sizzling aggressively.

FISH GLUTEN (batter) DAIRY (crema) CORN EGGS (mayo in crema)

Enchiladas Rojas

Shredded chicken, guajillo sauce, cotija, crema, pickled onion - Sell: \$17.99

10 min Main Target FC: 20%

Enchiladas Rojas



INGREDIENTS (3 ENCHILADAS)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Chicken thigh (shredded, batch)	120g	\$0.85
Corn tortillas (3)	90g	\$0.48
Guajillo enchilada sauce (batch)	180ml	\$0.36
Cotija cheese (crumbled)	30g	\$0.54
Mexican crema	30g	\$0.30
Pickled red onion (batch)	20g	\$0.06
Cilantro + lime	5g + wedge	\$0.08
Total cost (3 enchiladas)		\$2.67

Cost per serve	\$2.67
Sell price	\$17.99
Food cost %	14.8%
Contribution margin	\$15.32

METHOD

- 1 Poach chicken thighs in seasoned water (salt, garlic, bay, onion) at **85°C / 185°F** for 25 minutes. Pull apart into medium shreds. Season with salt and a little of the guajillo sauce. The poaching liquid becomes chicken stock — never discard it. Use it in the enchilada sauce or rice.
- 2 Guajillo sauce (batch): toast 6 guajillo + 2 ancho chilis, soak 20 min. Blend with 2 tomatoes, 3 garlic, 1 onion, 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp oregano, salt, and 300ml of the chicken poaching liquid. Strain through a medium sieve for a smooth sauce. Fry the sauce in a hot pan with a little oil for 5 minutes — this "frying" step intensifies the flavour and removes the raw chili taste. Makes 15+ serves.
- 3 Dip each corn tortilla briefly in warm guajillo sauce to coat and soften — 5 seconds per side. This sauce-dipping step is what makes an enchilada: it infuses the tortilla with chili flavour and makes it pliable enough to roll without cracking. A dry corn tortilla rolled cold will crack and break.
- 4 Fill each sauce-dipped tortilla with 40g shredded chicken. Roll tightly. Place seam-side down in a baking dish. Pour remaining sauce over. Bake at **180°C / 356°F** for **8 minutes** until heated through. Plate 3 per serve. Top with crumbled cotija, a drizzle of crema, pickled red onion, and cilantro.

Chef's Tip: Pickled red onion is an essential garnish — not decoration. Its sharp acidity cuts through the rich, earthy enchilada sauce and creamy cotija. Make it daily: red onion sliced thin + lime juice + salt + pinch sugar + 30 min rest. It softens slightly and turns a vivid pink. Make more than you need — it goes on almost everything in the taqueria.

POULTRY DAIRY (cotija, crema) CORN NIGHTSHADES

Huevos Rancheros

Fried eggs, ranchero sauce, black beans, tortilla, cotija · Sell: \$14.99

10 minMainTarget FC: 18%Breakfast hero

Huevos Rancheros



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Eggs (2)	110g	\$0.70
Corn tortillas (2, large)	60g	\$0.32
Ranchero sauce (batch)	100ml	\$0.20
Black beans (cooked, batch)	100g	\$0.24
Cotija cheese	20g	\$0.36
Avocado (quarter)	40g	\$0.48
Cilantro + jalapeño	5g + 8g	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$2.36

Cost per serve	\$2.36
Sell price	\$14.99
Food cost %	15.7%
Contribution margin	\$12.63

METHOD

- 1 Ranchero sauce (batch): char 4 roma tomatoes + 1 onion + 3 jalapeños + 4 garlic cloves on a comal until blackened. Blend coarsely — this should be a chunky sauce, not a smooth purée. Season. Fry in oil for 5 minutes to intensify. The charring of the vegetables is the entire character of ranchero sauce.
- 2 Black beans (batch): cook dried black beans from scratch with epazote (Mexican herb), garlic, onion until completely tender — 1.5–2 hours. Season generously with salt at the end only (salting early toughens the bean skin). Mash lightly — the beans should be mostly whole with a creamy consistency from the starchy cooking liquid. Canned beans are acceptable for service volume but the flavour difference is significant.
- 3 Warm corn tortillas on the comal. Fry eggs in a little oil — baste with the hot oil to cook the white without flipping. Yolk should remain runny; the whites should be fully set but not rubbery. The runny yolk mixing with the ranchero sauce on the plate is an essential part of the dish's flavour and visual appeal.
- 4 Plate tortillas, spoon warm beans on top, lay fried eggs over beans. Ladle ranchero sauce generously over and around. Add sliced avocado, crumbled cotija, cilantro. The dish should be vibrant, colourful, and substantial — this is a true breakfast main that carries a table through to mid-afternoon.

Chef's Tip: This dish is your highest-volume breakfast item and your best social media piece. The contrast of the bright red-orange ranchero sauce, white egg, dark beans, green avocado, and white cotija against the golden tortilla is one of the most naturally photogenic breakfast plates in any cuisine. Make sure every plate looks as good as it tastes.

EGGS DAIRY (cotija) CORN NIGHTSHADES

Carne Asada Burrito

Grilled skirt steak, rice, beans, guac, pico, crema, flour tortilla · Sell: \$17.99

10 min Main Target FC: 24%

Carne Asada Burrito



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Skirt steak (marinated)	130g	\$2.34
Large flour tortilla (12")	100g	\$0.48
Mexican rice (batch)	100g cooked	\$0.22
Black beans (batch)	80g	\$0.18
Guacamole	50g	\$0.60
Pico de gallo (batch)	50g	\$0.16
Mexican crema	20g	\$0.20
Total cost per serve		\$4.18

Cost per serve	\$4.18
Sell price	\$17.99
Food cost %	23.2%
Contribution margin	\$13.81

METHOD

- 1 Carne asada marinade: lime juice + orange juice + garlic + jalapeño + cilantro + cumin + salt + oil.
Marinate skirt steak minimum 2 hours. The citrus juice tenderises the tough skirt steak connective tissue — the acid denatures surface protein and allows the marinade flavours to penetrate deeply.
- 2 Grill skirt steak on a ripping hot comal or griddle — 230°C / 446°F . 2–3 minutes per side for medium-rare: 55°C / 131°F . Medium: 60°C / 140°F . Rest 3 minutes. Slice against the grain — skirt steak has a very pronounced grain and slicing with it produces an impossibly chewy result. Against the grain cuts through the fibres and produces a tender slice.
- 3 Mexican rice (batch): toast dry rice in oil until golden (3 min). Add blended tomato + garlic + onion, let absorb. Add chicken stock 1:1.8 ratio. Simmer covered 18 minutes. The toasting step creates a nuttiness and seals each grain so the rice cooks fluffy rather than sticky.
- 4 Warm flour tortilla on comal 20 seconds each side. Layer components in a line down the centre — rice first (acts as a base layer), beans, steak, guac, pico, crema. Roll tightly: fold in sides first, roll from the bottom with firm tension. The burrito should feel dense and tight. Sear the wrapped burrito on the comal seam-side down for 1 minute to seal it and add a light char.

Chef's Tip: The order of layers inside a burrito is not arbitrary. Rice at the base insulates the tortilla from moisture. Beans next for structural body. Protein in the centre. Wet components (guac, crema, pico) last. This sequence ensures the tortilla doesn't go soggy within the 5 minutes between wrapping and eating — critical for takeaway orders especially.

BEEF GLUTEN (flour tortilla) DAIRY (crema) NIGHTSHADES

Chilaquiles Rojos

Crispy tortilla chips, guajillo sauce, fried egg, crema, cotija · Sell: \$14.99

8 minMainTarget FC: 16%Breakfast hero

Chilaquiles



INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
House tortilla chips (fresh)	80g	\$0.42
Guajillo sauce (batch)	150ml	\$0.30
Eggs (2, fried)	110g	\$0.70
Mexican crema	25g	\$0.25
Cotija (crumbled)	20g	\$0.36
Pickled red onion	15g	\$0.04
Cilantro	5g	\$0.04
Total cost per serve		\$2.11

Cost per serve	\$2.11
Sell price	\$14.99
Food cost %	14.1%
Contribution margin	\$12.88

METHOD

- Chilaquiles must be made and served in under 3 minutes once the chips hit the sauce — the whole character of the dish depends on timing. Too long and the chips dissolve to mush. Too short and the chips don't absorb any sauce. The window is approximately 60–90 seconds of cooking after sauce contact.
- Heat guajillo sauce in a wide pan to a simmer. Add fresh house chips in one movement. Toss gently to coat every chip — use tongs or a flat spatula. Cook 60–90 seconds. The chips should be coated and slightly softened on the outside while retaining some crunch at their core. This contrast is the defining texture of properly made chilaquiles.
- Plate immediately from the pan — do not hold. Lay fried eggs on top (basted in hot oil, yolk runny). Drizzle crema over. Crumble cotija. Add pickled onion and cilantro. The garnishes are applied in this sequence: crema first (it needs to settle), then cheese, then the delicate items.

Chef's Tip: This is your fastest breakfast item and your best food cost item — using house chips means you're converting a \$0.42 input into a \$14.99 dish. It is also a Mexican street food classic that resonates strongly with guests who've eaten in Mexico. The "crunch-to-soft" ratio is the technique benchmark: aim for 70% sauce-softened, 30% still crunchy.

EGGS DAIRY (crema, cotija) CORN NIGHTSHADES

Tamales de Pollo (2-pack)

Masa, chicken tinga, salsa verde, crema - Sell: \$13.99

8 min service Main Target FC: 18% Batch weekly

Tamales



INGREDIENTS (2 TAMALES)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Masa harina (batch)	120g dry	\$0.24
Lard or shortening	40g	\$0.18
Chicken tinga filling	80g	\$0.72
Corn husks (dried, soaked)	4 husks	\$0.08
Salsa verde (side)	60ml	\$0.10
Mexican crema	20g	\$0.20
Total cost (2 tamales)		\$1.52

Cost per serve	\$1.52
Sell price	\$13.99
Food cost %	10.9%
Contribution margin	\$12.47

METHOD (BATCH — MAKE 2X PER WEEK)

- 1 Masa dough: beat lard until light and fluffy — this aeration step is what gives tamale masa its soft, light texture after steaming. Add masa harina, chicken stock, salt. Mix until a smooth, pliable dough forms.
Test: a small ball of masa dropped in water should float. If it sinks, continue beating with more fat.
- 2 Chicken tinga filling: shred poached chicken thighs. Sauté with chipotle in adobo + strained tomatoes + onion + garlic + oregano until the sauce coats the chicken and has reduced to a thick, clingy consistency — not wet. Wet filling creates a soggy tamale interior.
- 3 Soak dried corn husks in hot water 30 minutes until pliable. Spread 60g masa in a thin even layer on each husk leaving 3cm border. Add 40g tinga filling in a line down the centre. Fold the husk sides inward over the filling, then fold the bottom up. Steam upright in a steamer for **60–70 minutes**. The tamale is done when the masa pulls cleanly away from the husk.
- 4 Service: reheat by steaming 10 minutes or microwave 2 minutes wrapped in damp paper. Unwrap at the table or plate with husks partially folded back as a presentation element. Serve with salsa verde and crema. The husk should be part of the visual — it communicates authenticity immediately.

Chef's Tip: Tamales are labour-intensive but batch beautifully — make 50–80 at once, freeze them, and steam to order. A frozen tamale steams from frozen in 15 minutes with zero quality loss. Having tamales in the freezer is essentially having a fully-prepared premium item with a 3-month shelf life. This makes them the most operationally intelligent item on the menu.

POULTRY CORN DAIRY (crema) NIGHTSHADES

Churros con Chocolate

Fresh fried churros, cinnamon sugar, thick Mexican chocolate dip · Sell: \$9.99

8 min Dessert Target FC: 14%

Churros



INGREDIENTS (5 CHURROS + DIP)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Choux dough (batch)	100g piped	\$0.18
Cinnamon sugar	20g	\$0.04
Dark chocolate 60%	40g	\$0.56
Heavy cream (for ganache)	40ml	\$0.40
Frying oil (portion)	50ml	\$0.10
Total cost per serve		\$1.28

Cost per serve	\$1.28
Sell price	\$9.99
Food cost %	12.8%
Contribution margin	\$8.71

METHOD

- 1 Churro dough: bring 250ml water + 30g butter + pinch salt + pinch sugar to a boil. Add 150g plain flour all at once, stir vigorously until dough pulls away from pan sides (2 minutes). Cool 5 minutes. Beat in 2 eggs one at a time — the dough will look broken at first but comes together into a smooth, pipeable choux paste. Load into a piping bag with a large star nozzle.
- 2 Heat oil to 180°C / 356°F. Pipe churros directly into the oil — cut at 10cm with scissors. Fry 3–4 minutes, turning once, until deep golden. The star nozzle creates the ridged surface that is essential for both texture (maximum crunch) and the cinnamon-sugar coating to cling to. A round nozzle produces a smooth churro that sheds its coating immediately.
- 3 Drain, roll immediately in cinnamon sugar while hot. Chocolate dipping sauce: heat cream to just simmering, pour over chopped dark chocolate. Stir until smooth — this is a simple ganache. Add a pinch of cinnamon and a tiny pinch of cayenne for the Mexican chocolate character.

Chef's Tip: Churros must be served within 5 minutes of frying — they go from perfect to soft within 10 minutes. For service efficiency, keep piped dough in the fridge in the piping bag and fry to order. Each order takes 4 minutes from cold dough to plate — build this into your server communication: "The churros take 4 minutes — worth the wait."

GLUTEN EGGS DAIRY

Tres Leches Cake

Three-milk soaked sponge, whipped cream, cinnamon · Sell: \$8.99

3 min service · Dessert · Target FC: 13% · Set overnight

Tres Leches



INGREDIENTS (PER SLICE)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Vanilla sponge (batch)	100g slice	\$0.24
Evaporated milk	40ml (batch)	\$0.16
Condensed milk	30ml (batch)	\$0.20
Heavy cream (soak)	30ml (batch)	\$0.30
Whipped cream (topping)	40g	\$0.22
Cinnamon + strawberries	2g + 20g	\$0.12
Total cost per slice		\$1.24

Cost per serve	\$1.24
Sell price	\$8.99
Food cost %	13.8%
Contribution margin	\$7.75

METHOD (BATCH — MAKE DAY BEFORE)

- 1 Bake a light vanilla sponge — eggs separated, yolks beaten with sugar until pale, whites beaten to stiff peaks and folded in. The aerated texture of the separated-egg sponge is essential — it must be light enough to absorb the milk mixture without collapsing into a dense, wet mass.
- 2 While sponge is still warm, poke all over with a skewer or fork — hundreds of small holes. Mix the three milks: evaporated milk + condensed milk + heavy cream. Pour the entire mixture slowly over the warm sponge. The warm sponge absorbs more readily than a cold one. The sponge should look completely saturated.
- 3 Refrigerate overnight minimum — the milk soak needs 8+ hours to fully absorb and for the texture to set to a dense, custard-like consistency. A same-day tres leches has unabsorbed milk pooling at the bottom and an inconsistent texture.
- 4 Service: slice and plate. Top with freshly whipped cream (whip daily — never use pre-whipped). Dust with cinnamon. Add a strawberry. The contrast of the impossibly moist, sweet sponge against the lightly sweet cream and the warm spice of cinnamon is the complete flavour profile.

Chef's Tip: Tres leches is one of the most forgiving desserts in a commercial kitchen — it improves over 2–3 days in the fridge, it's impossible to over-soak, and it requires zero technique at service (slice + cream + cinnamon). The challenge is the sponge: it must be genuinely light and airy. A dense sponge won't absorb the milk evenly and produces a gummy texture.

EGGS · DAIRY · GLUTEN

Flan de Vainilla

Classic caramel custard flan, inverted to order · Sell: \$7.99

3 min service Dessert Target FC: 14% Set overnight

Flan



INGREDIENTS (PER RAMEKIN)

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	COST
Whole eggs	2 × 55g	\$0.70
Egg yolks	2 × 18g	\$0.35
Whole milk	200ml	\$0.30
Sweetened condensed milk	100ml	\$0.66
Sugar (caramel)	60g	\$0.06
Vanilla extract	3ml	\$0.06
Total cost per ramekin		\$2.13

Cost per serve	\$2.13
Sell price	\$7.99
Food cost %	26.7%
Contribution margin	\$5.86

METHOD (BATCH — BAKE AND REFRIGERATE DAY BEFORE)

- 1 Caramel: heat 60g sugar in a dry pan without stirring until it melts and turns deep amber at **170°C / 338°F**. Pour immediately into ramekins, tilting to coat the base. Work fast — caramel sets within 30 seconds. The caramel layer at the base becomes the sauce when the flan is inverted.
- 2 Custard: blend eggs, yolks, condensed milk, whole milk, vanilla until smooth. Strain through a fine sieve to remove any egg chalazae (white strings) that would create texture irregularities in the set custard. Pour into caramel-lined ramekins.
- 3 Bake in a water bath at **150°C / 302°F** for **40–45 minutes**. The flan is done when the edges are set and the centre wobbles gently — like set jello, not liquid. The low temperature water bath ensures an even, smooth set without bubbles or cracks. Refrigerate overnight — minimum 6 hours. The texture firms and the caramel layer liquefies slightly.
- 4 Service: run a thin knife around the edge of the ramekin. Place a plate firmly on top and invert in one decisive motion. The caramel will flow over the flan as a sauce. The flan should be smooth, golden-caramel coloured, trembling. Serve immediately — flan at room temperature within 5 minutes of inverting is at its peak.

Chef's Tip: Mexican flan uses condensed milk rather than cream, which produces a denser, sweeter, more intensely flavoured custard than French crème caramel. The condensed milk also makes it more forgiving to bake. If your flan is pitting or bubbling on the surface, your oven temperature is too high — reduce by 10°C and increase cooking time by 5 minutes.

EGGS DAIRY

Horchata



Horchata de Arroz

\$5.99

Cold rice milk with cinnamon and vanilla. Made fresh daily — never from powder. Creamy, sweet, spiced. The essential taqueria drink that cools down any spicy dish instantly.

Cost	\$0.44
Food cost %	7.3%

Jamaica



Agua de Jamaica

\$4.99

Hibiscus flower agua fresca. Tart, floral, deep ruby red. Zero artificial colour — the colour comes entirely from dried hibiscus. Served over ice with a lime wheel.

Cost	\$0.28
Food cost %	5.6%

Michelada



Michelada

\$9.99

Mexican lager + lime juice + hot sauce + Worcestershire + Tajín-rimmed glass. The Mexican brunch cocktail. Non-alcoholic option available (replace beer with sparkling water — a "Virgin Michelada").

Cost	\$1.80
Food cost %	18.0%

Café de Olla



Café de Olla

\$5.50

Mexican spiced black coffee brewed with cinnamon stick and piloncillo (raw cane sugar). Served black in a clay cup. Rich, aromatic, earthy — nothing like regular drip coffee.

Cost	\$0.44
Food cost %	8.0%

Agua de Sandía



Agua de Sandía

\$4.99

Fresh watermelon blended with lime juice and a pinch of salt. No sugar added — the watermelon provides all the sweetness. Vivid pink, naturally beautiful, changes daily based on the fruit.

Cost	\$0.38
Food cost %	7.6%

Margarita



House Margarita

\$11.99

Blanco tequila, fresh lime juice, triple sec, salt rim. No sour mix — ever. Shaken with ice, served on the rocks or straight up. The only cocktail on the menu, done perfectly.

Cost	\$2.20
Food cost %	18.4%

Tamarindo



Agua de Tamarindo

\$4.99

Tamarind paste dissolved in water with sugar and a squeeze of lime. Tangy, sweet, slightly funky — one of the most distinctive agua frescas and a reliable conversation starter with first-timers.

Cost	\$0.32
Food cost %	6.4%



Champurrado

\$6.50

Thick Mexican hot chocolate made with masa harina, dark chocolate, cinnamon, and piloncillo. Richer and more substantial than hot cocoa — it is a drink and a light meal simultaneously. Traditional breakfast drink.

Cost	\$0.72
Food cost %	11.1%

Kitchen Prep Flow — 7:00am to 3:00pm

Team: Head Cook (HC) + Line Cook (LC) + Steward (ST). Taqueria service is fast — average ticket 8 minutes. Morning prep is non-negotiable: everything must be ready before the first guest arrives.

	Head Cook	Line Cook	Steward
07:00–07:30	Temp check all cold units — log. All fridges: 1–4°C . Pull carnitas and birria from fridge — begin reheating in their juices at low heat. Taste both — adjust seasoning. Check al pastor is thawed and ready to grill.	Station setup. Comal on, heat to 200°C . Pull all batch salsas — roja, verde, chipotle crema. Check freshness, taste, adjust. Set up taco station: tortillas, proteins, garnishes in wells. Cut limes.	Sanitise all surfaces. Set up drink stations: horchata, jamaica, tamarindo all made fresh. Juice limes for margaritas and agua frescas. Grind coffee for café de olla. Set tables and stock condiments: Tabasco, Valentina, salt, Tajin.
07:30–09:00	Make fresh guacamole batch (holds max 2 hours — make in 2 batches: 7:30 and 10:30). Make pico de gallo fresh. Check birria consommé — strain, reheat to 74°C+ . Prepare churro dough — load into piping bags, refrigerate.	Fry first chip batch — season, portion into bags. Make pickled red onions if needed. Set up fish station: portion cod, prepare beer batter (keep on ice). Hard-boil eggs for huevos rancheros (10 min). Check tamales inventory — steam batch if needed.	Make watermelon agua fresca fresh. Set up dessert station: slice tres leches, plate flan in ramekins ready to invert, chocolate ganache for churros warmed. Stock all drink glasses with ice. Brief FOH on today's 86 items.
09:00–11:00 Breakfast Service	Run pass — calls every order. Fires huevos rancheros (10 min) and chilaquiles (8 min, timing critical). Monitors comal temps. Ensures guacamole is made fresh every 2 hours — never serve oxidised guac. Manages ticket board.	Executes all breakfast mains. Chilaquiles timing: sauces hit chips max 90 seconds before plating. Huevos eggs fried to order — yolk runny. Breakfast burritos assembled to order. Calls to HC if any protein running low.	Runs drinks — agua frescas, café de olla, champurrado. Runs food to tables immediately — hot tortillas go cold fast. Clears continuously. Alert HC at 10:30 to make second guacamole batch.
11:00–11:30 Transition	Transition to lunch mains. Check carnitas, al pastor, birria are all at service temp and portioned. Confirm fish batter is cold and fresh. Grill al pastor slices — keep warm. Start enchilada sauce batch warming.	Break down breakfast station. Set up for lunch: taco production line ready (tortillas, proteins, garnishes in sequence). Portion skirt steak for carne asada. Set up fryer for fish tacos and churros.	Full reset. Restock all drink stations — fresh agua frescas, ice levels. Set up margarita station. Restock all condiments and garnish wells. Clear and reset all tables.
11:30–14:30 Lunch Service	High-volume taco service. Monitors all protein stations. Calls orders with precise timing. Ensures birria quesadillas are sizzling when they leave — theatre is part of the dish. Manages fryer temp for fish tacos.	Executes all mains at speed: tacos in 7 min, burritos in 10 min, enchiladas in 10 min. Maintains comal cleanliness between orders. Communicates proactively when any protein is getting low.	Maximum speed service — tacos go cold in 4 minutes, deliver immediately. Margarita and drink service at peak. Dessert upsell at 20-minute mark: churros (4 min), tres leches (2 min), flan (2 min).
14:30–15:00 Close	Ice-bath all hot proteins to cool below 21°C within 2 hours . Label and date all containers. Write tomorrow's prep list. Note what ran out, what was over-prepped. Schedule tamale batch if needed.	Break down comal and all stations — clean thoroughly. Wrap and store all proteins. Discard any salsa older than 24 hours. Clean fryer. Check all salsas dated and stored correctly.	Full kitchen clean. Sanitise all surfaces. Empty all bins. Final fridge temp check — log all units. All cold storage: 1–4°C before leaving.

Financial Forecast — US Market

Assumptions: 32 seats · Fast-casual model · Breakfast avg \$28 · Lunch avg \$38 · 26 trading days/month ·

Staff: Head Cook \$20/hr, Line Cook \$17/hr, Steward \$14/hr, FOH x1 \$15/hr

Service	Covers	Avg Spend	Daily Revenue
Breakfast (7am–11am)	44	\$28	\$1,232
Lunch (11:30am–2:30pm)	62	\$38	\$2,356
Daily Total			\$3,588
Monthly (26 days)			\$93,288

Cost Category	Monthly Cost	% Revenue
Food & Beverage (COGS) — 22%	\$20,523	22.0%
Head Cook \$20/hr × 8 × 26	\$4,160	4.5%
Line Cook \$17/hr × 8 × 26	\$3,536	3.8%
Steward \$14/hr × 8 × 26	\$2,912	3.1%
FOH x1 \$15/hr × 8 × 26	\$3,120	3.3%
Total Labour	\$13,728	14.7%
Rent + Utilities + Misc	\$5,800	6.2%
Total All Costs	\$40,051	42.9%
NET PROFIT (at capacity)	\$53,237	57.1%

Break-even: Daily fixed costs ~\$742 ÷ (\$33 avg × 78% GP) = ~29 covers/day. A taqueria with 32 seats typically crosses break-even before 10am on a normal day.

Month	Capacity	Revenue	Est. Net Profit
Month 1 — Learning	60%	\$55,973	~\$8,500
Month 2 — Building	80%	\$74,630	~\$26,000
Month 3 — Cruising	100%	\$93,288	~\$53,237

7 Service Training Module

SCRIPT 1 — THE TECHNIQUE STORY

"The carnitas are cooked for 12 hours in their own fat with orange and lime. We don't rush it — the pork has to fall apart on its own terms. It's \$16.99 for three tacos and they come with both salsas. Worth it."

Why it works: "12 hours" communicates craft. "Their own terms" is slightly poetic and memorable. Direct price disclosure removes hesitation.

SCRIPT 2 — THE DRINK PAIRING

"Can I get you a horchata or agua fresca with that? The horchata is house-made with rice and cinnamon — it's really good with anything spicy. It's \$5.99. Or a margarita if you're going that way — \$11.99, fresh lime only."

Why it works: Offering two options at very different price points catches both non-drinkers and drinkers. "Fresh lime only" on the margarita communicates quality without a lecture.

SCRIPT 3 — THE GUAC OPENER

"The guac is made every two hours here — it's \$12.99 with chips and both salsas. It's actually one of the better starters to share while you decide. We go through a lot of it."

Why it works: "Every two hours" signals freshness. "While you decide" positions it as helpful, not salesy. Social proof ("we go through a lot") removes ordering hesitation.

SCRIPT 4 — THE CHURROS PLANT

"Quick note — the churros are fried to order, they take about 4 minutes. If you want them, tell me now and I'll time them to come out right after your main. They're \$9.99 with a chocolate dip."

Why it works: Pre-ordering churros with mains is a service act that also pre-sells dessert. Most guests say yes when framed as a timing convenience rather than an upsell.

SCRIPT 5 — THE REGULAR BUILDER

"Are you in the area? Every Tuesday we do a taco special — three different tacos, one of each protein, with a horchata. Worth coming back for if you like variety."

Why it works: Gives a specific day and a specific reason. Tuesday specials create weekly rituals — the most powerful form of customer retention in fast-casual.

Table Timing Guide

Time	Action
0:00	Welcome immediately. At a taqueria, speed of acknowledgement is part of the brand. "Welcome in — grab any seat, menus are on the table."
1:00	Drink order — use Script 2. Offer agua frescas proactively: "We make all our aguas fresh daily — horchata, jamaica, watermelon, tamarind."
2:00	Deploy Script 3 (guac opener) and Script 4 (churro plant). Both at order time, not separately.
4:00	Take full food order. Use Script 1 for carnitas or al pastor if they're deciding. Confirm chilli tolerance for spicy items.
12:00	Check in 2 min after food arrives. Refill agua frescas — offer second round proactively. Ask how the heat level is.
20:00	Churros arrive (if pre-ordered). If not, offer: "Churros take 4 min — want me to put some in?"
28:00	Bill on request. Use Script 5 (Tuesday special) with every first-time guest. Say thanks genuinely.

8 Customer Retention System

The Taqueria Principle: The best taquerias in the world have lines out the door not because of marketing — because someone's abuela makes the tortillas by hand at 6am and regulars can taste the difference. Authenticity and consistency are the retention system. Build habits, not loyalty cards.

3-Visit Rule:

Visit 1: Execute perfectly. Note what they ordered and their heat preference.

Visit 2: "The carnitas again?" shows you remembered. Write their name after they leave.

Visit 3: "The usual?" — you just made a regular for life.

5 VIP Micro-Moments

- 1. The Salsa Introduction.** For first-timers, take 30 seconds to explain the two salsas: "The roja is smoky and medium, the verde is brighter and a little hotter." This small act of education makes guests feel oriented and cared for — and prevents the awkward "which one is hotter?" conversation at the table.
- 2. The Fresh Tortilla Moment.** If you make tortillas in-house, let the aroma do the work. Position the comal where guests can see and smell the tortillas cooking. This sensory signal communicates authenticity more powerfully than any marketing message.
- 3. The Complimentary Agua.** On hot days, send a small complimentary cup of watermelon agua fresca to the table with the menu. Cost: \$0.19. Signal: this place takes care of you.
- 4. The Heat Check.** After a guest's first bite of something spicy, check in: "How's the heat for you?" This shows attentiveness and gives you information for future visits — note their preference.
- 5. The Tuesday Reminder.** When a regular comes in on any day other than Tuesday, remind them: "Don't forget our Tuesday special — three tacos, one of each protein." You're giving them a gift (information), not making a sales pitch.

Complaint Recovery

Step 1 — Listen. Full stop. No explaining, no defending. At a taqueria, guests expect directness — match it by

receiving the complaint without defensiveness.

Step 2 — Own it. "You're right, that's not how it should be. I'm sorry." Short and genuine. No corporate language.

Step 3 — Fix it fast. Remake or replace immediately. "I'm putting a fresh order in right now — it'll be 7 minutes. Your drinks are on us." Speed of recovery at a fast-casual taqueria is the brand.

BEST SOCIAL MEDIA SHOT — AL PASTOR

We start marinating at midnight. [Hook]

Achiote, guajillo, ancho, chipotle, orange juice, pineapple. The pork sits in that for 12 hours before it ever sees heat. Then it goes on the comal at full blast until the edges char. Then it gets pineapple. That's al pastor.

That's why it tastes the way it does. [Story]

Open 7am. Come hungry. [CTA]